to allow time for reconsideration. Levin, the justice minister, answered immediately: the reform will not be stopped for a minute, it will be pushed ahead. It is not clear whether Levin is merely Netanyahu's mouthpiece or the quasi-autonomous fanatic he seems to be, one of course working in unison with Netanyahu.

Monday, February 6

Levin has suggested introducing the judicial overhaul in several successive steps, leaving some of the most controversial propositions for later months, but accelerating others. His main acolyte is possibly more dangerous than he is: Religious Zionist Party's Simcha Rotman, head of the judiciary committee of the Knesset. His most urgent aim seems to be the reinstating of Aryeh Deri. Most probably, the postponed propositions are not yet ready. Those that are submitted should get voted on before the Knesset adjourns in April.

As for Ben-Gvir, he has abstained, notwithstanding his fiery declarations, from destroying the large building in East Jerusalem he promised to bring down. Two steps ahead, one step backward.

Three things are quite bothersome regarding the protest movement: the lack of leadership, the quasi-total exclusion of the Palestinian issue, and the danger of again having a majority of Ashkenazim facing the great mass of Sephardim. Nobody wants that, but the fact is that the Likud has a majority of Sephardi voters. Avoiding this trap should be an important aim of those who organize the demonstrations. There should be many more Alsheichs. Those who remember the Peace Now days will remember that the movement was soon tagged as Ashkenazi and elitist—which harmed and probably put an end to a movement that indeed did not represent the wider population.